



WFP Zimbabwe

COUNTRY BRIEF

June 2026



10,211 people assisted in May 2026
(53 percent female)



150 mt food distributed in May 2026



USD 70,260 cash transferred in May 2026



USD 41.7 M required in the next six months (June- November 2026)

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- WFP Zimbabwe and the Embassy of Japan, represented by Mr. Tetsuya Murakami, Counsellor, conducted a joint field mission to Chipinge to review progress under Japan's USD 5 million support for smallholder farmer and sesame value chain development. The mission highlighted gains in resilient food systems, market access and improved livelihoods for participating communities.
- Forecasts from the World Meteorological Organisation (WMO) indicate potential El Niño conditions from September 2026 to February 2027. The phenomenon, which is expected to affect Southern Africa, is likely to impact Zimbabwe's 2026/2027 agricultural season through below-average rainfall, prolonged dry spells, reduced crop production and heightened food insecurity risks for vulnerable households.

SITUATION OVERVIEW

- Zimbabwe is closely monitoring forecasts from the World Meteorological Organization (WMO) and the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA), which indicate the potential for El Niño conditions during the 2026/2027 agricultural season. While more localised and detailed forecasts from the National Climate Outlook Forum are expected in August, the Government of Zimbabwe, supported by WFP and partners, is enhancing preparedness through anticipatory action, climate risk monitoring, early warning systems and contingency planning to safeguard food security, protect livelihoods and reduce the impact of potential climate-related shocks on vulnerable communities.
- Zimbabwe continues to face intersecting climatic and structural pressures that are driving food insecurity and livelihood stress. Recurrent climate shocks have disrupted agricultural production, increasing vulnerability in both rural and urban areas.
- Through its 2022–2026 Country Strategic Plan, WFP Zimbabwe is delivering life-saving food and nutrition assistance while scaling up resilience-building efforts and strengthening early warning and social protection systems. At the same time, WFP is investing in government capacity to lead and ultimately assume full ownership of programme delivery, while partnering with the private sector to accelerate progress towards Zero Hunger.

Reporting Period: June 2026

Photo Caption & Credit: Mr Tetsuya Murakami, Counsellor at the Embassy of Japan in Zimbabwe, observes sesame marketing at a Village Business Unit in Chipinge. WFP/Tinashe Mubaira

OPERATIONAL UPDATES

General Food Assistance

- In May, WFP assisted 10,200 refugees residing at Tongogara Refugee Camp with food assistance. The support package included specialised nutritious products for children under five years of age, as well as for pregnant and breastfeeding women and people with chronic illnesses, to help meet their specific nutritional needs and improve overall health outcomes.

Social Protection

- WFP Zimbabwe continues to strengthen national social protection systems, including through its engagement in the ongoing review of the National Social Protection Policy Framework (NSPPF) and the National Social Protection Strategy. As part of this process, in May, WFP participated in the NSPPF validation process, contributing technical expertise and operational insights. This engagement helps ensure that the revised frameworks are responsive to emerging vulnerabilities, promote shock-responsive social protection, and enhance coordination across stakeholders, ultimately supporting more effective and inclusive assistance for vulnerable populations. It also strengthens the Government's capacity to progressively take over the implementation of Lean Season Assistance (LSA) during protracted and predictable periods of food insecurity, an approach expected to be tested during the 2027 LSA response.
- WFP Zimbabwe also participated in the national workshop to validate the Zimbabwe Social Registry Manual, a key tool for harmonizing programme implementation across development partners. The Social Registry will strengthen targeting, improve efficiency and transparency in beneficiary selection, and support better coordination of social protection interventions, ultimately enhancing the delivery of assistance to vulnerable populations.

Resilience and Livelihood Support

- WFP Zimbabwe and the Embassy of Japan, represented by Mr. Tetsuya Murakami,

Counsellor, conducted a field mission to Chipinge district to review progress under Japan's USD 5 million contribution provided in 2024. The funding, which runs through November 2027, supports the strengthening of food systems through the development of the sesame value chain using a farm-to-fork approach, linking smallholder farmers to markets, including Japanese companies as off-takers and the Japanese domestic market as an export market.

- The mission reviewed key achievements under the Integrated Rural Resilience Building programme, highlighting strong partnerships with government departments at grassroots level to provide technical support and sustain results. Collaboration with the private sector is also reinforcing the SHEP (Smallholder Horticulture Empowerment and Promotion) approach by facilitating access to structured markets, notably for chilli and sesame destined for export. The mission further showcased progress along the sesame value chain, where smallholder farmers are increasingly accessing reliable markets, including sales to SES Africa, another Japan-supported partner. The mission highlighted strong progress in resilience building, market access, strengthened livelihoods and improved nutrition outcomes among participating rural communities.

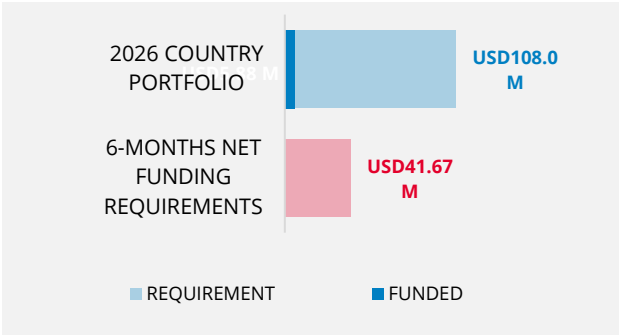
Youth Empowerment and Livelihoods Programme

- In 2025, WFP Zimbabwe enrolled its first cohort of 10 youth under its inaugural Youth Empowerment and Livelihoods Programme (YELP), marking a new milestone in its resilience and livelihoods portfolio to address youth unemployment and vulnerability. The programme focuses on boosting skills development, leadership, and meaningful youth participation to tackle unemployment and unlock new economic opportunities. In May, YELP interns participated in post-harvest management training, strengthening their capacity to engage in local food systems and livelihoods activities. By equipping young people with market-relevant competencies and strengthening their engagement in local economies, YELP is expected to enhance

self-reliance, promote innovation, and contribute to improved livelihoods and food security among Zimbabwe’s youth.

Sharing our story

- In May, WFP Zimbabwe launched the second episode of its podcast, Bites of Change, an innovative platform designed to strengthen accountability to the communities and people WFP serves while broadening stakeholder engagement for the development of the Country Strategic Plan (2027–2031). Through conversations with WFP staff, partners, experts and community voices, the podcast explores food security, nutrition and development challenges, shows locally driven solutions, and creates space for stakeholders to share their perspectives and experiences. With two episodes now produced ([Episode 1](#), [Episode 2](#)), Bites of Change serves as both an advocacy and knowledge-sharing tool, inviting audiences to join the conversation and contribute to Zimbabwe's development journey through shared insights from partners and communities.



Donors

Africa Development Bank, ARC, CERF, European Commission through ECHO, Germany, Japan, Korea, LDS, Russia, Switzerland, United Kingdom, United States of America, WFP’s Emerging Donors Matching Fund, Zimbabwe (in alphabetical order).

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FUNDING OVERVIEW
[Country Strategic Plan \(2022-2026\)](#)